

Combinatorics Cameron - Solutions Manual

Mingruifu Lin

September 2025

Contents

1	On Numbers and Counting	5
---	-------------------------	---

Chapter 1

On Numbers and Counting

Exercise 1

Missing proof of existence of largest natural number, so cannot say "let n be the largest...".

Exercise 2

Fuh naw.

Exercise 3

(a) Clearly, the base case works: $1 > \frac{1}{e}$. Now suppose

$$n! > \left(\frac{n}{e}\right)^n$$

Then

$$(n+1)n! > (n+1)\left(\frac{n}{e}\right)^n$$

We derive the right hand side:

$$= (n+1)\left(\frac{n}{n+1}\right)^n \left(\frac{n+1}{e}\right)^n$$

Using the fact that $(1 + \frac{1}{n})^n < e \Rightarrow \frac{1}{(1+\frac{1}{n})^n} > \frac{1}{e} \Rightarrow \left(\frac{n}{n+1}\right)^n > \frac{1}{e}$, we replace the middle term to create the inequality

$$\begin{aligned} &> (n+1)\frac{1}{e}\left(\frac{n+1}{e}\right)^n \\ &= \left(\frac{n+1}{e}\right)^{n+1} \end{aligned}$$

Hence induction step completed.

(b) The first inequality is equivalent to

$$\sqrt[n]{n!} < \frac{n+1}{2}$$

The left side is the geometric mean from 1 to n . The right side is the arithmetic mean from 1 to n . The theorem tells us that the geometric mean is smaller than the arithmetic mean.

Once again, we use the same strategy as (a).

$$\begin{aligned} n! &< \left(\frac{n+1}{2}\right)^n \\ &= \left(\frac{n}{n}\right)^n \left(\frac{n+1}{2}\right)^n \\ &= \left(\frac{n+1}{n}\right)^n \left(\frac{n}{2}\right)^n \\ &= \left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right)^n \left(\frac{n}{2}\right)^n \\ &< e \left(\frac{n}{2}\right)^n \end{aligned}$$

Hence proven.

Exercise 4

(a) Given, $\log x$ and x^c for $c > 0$, since both go to infinity, we apply L'Hopital's

$$\lim \frac{\log x}{x^c} = \lim \frac{\frac{1}{x}}{c \frac{1}{x^{1-c}}} = \frac{1}{c} \lim x^{-c} = 0$$

(b) Given $c, d > 1$, we know

$$\lim \frac{c^x}{x^d} = \infty$$

which is equivalent to the existence of x such that $\frac{c^x}{x^d} > M$ for any M . Simply choose $M = 1$. Since c^x is positive, in order to produce positive result greater than 1, it follows that x^d must be positive. Hence, there exists x such that $\frac{c^x}{x^d} > 1 \Rightarrow c^x > x^d$ with no sign flip.

Exercise 5

Not sure what unlabelled means.

Exercise 8

There are 2^n configurations of inputs. For each of the 2^n configurations, we have 2 output options, either true or false, hence 2^{2^n} boolean functions.

Exercise 9

I think studying set theory would be more beneficial and effective than this question. Skipped.

Exercise 10

$$\frac{g(n)}{f(n)} > \frac{kc^n}{bn^d}$$

for some b, k and sufficiently large n . By L'Hopital's, the right limit tends to infinity, hence there exists N such that the right side is greater than 1 for all $n \geq N$ (similar to Exercise 4). Hence $g(n) > f(n)$ for $n \geq N$.

Exercise 11

For the first, since b subsets each with k elements, then the combined total count of elements of bk . For the second, there are v elements, each found in exactly r subsets, which adds up to vr , which is also the combined total count of elements in subsets.

Exercise 12

(i) Too lazy. Pretty intuitive and obvious.

Exercise 13

192

Exercise 14

Number of books:

$$B = 25^{410 \cdot 40 \cdot 80}$$

Number of rooms:

$$R = \frac{B}{20 \cdot 35}$$